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Financing of the United Nations Interim Security Force for Abyei

Budget performance for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025 and proposed budget for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 of the United Nations Interim Security Force for Abyei

Report of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions

Appropriation for 2024/25	\$297,776,200
Allotment for 2024/25	\$296,804,800
Expenditure for 2024/25	\$296,804,100
Unencumbered balance for 2024/25	\$972,100
Appropriation for 2025/26	\$309,120,900
Projected expenditure for 2025/26 ^{a,b}	\$266,789,700
Projected underexpenditure for 2025/26 ^a	\$42,331,200
Proposal submitted by the Secretary-General for 2026/27	\$277,238,100
Adjustment recommended by the Advisory Committee for 2026/27	(\$1,398,800)
Recommendation of the Advisory Committee for 2026/27	\$275,839,300

^a Estimates as at 28 February 2026.

^b Excludes one-time requirements for the termination entitlements payable to staff members.

* Reissued for technical reasons on 27 April 2026.



I. Introduction

1. During its consideration of the report on the financing of the United Nations Interim Security Force for Abyei (UNISFA) (A/80/614), the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions met with representatives of the Secretary-General, who provided additional information and clarification, concluding with written responses received on 1 April 2026. The comments and recommendations of the Committee on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations are contained in its report (A/80/604), and those pertaining to the findings and recommendations of the Board of Auditors on the United Nations peacekeeping operations for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025 can be found in its related report (A/80/633).

II. Budget performance report for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025

2. By its resolution 78/297, the General Assembly appropriated an amount of \$297,776,200 gross (\$293,392,600 net) for the maintenance of the Force for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025. A total allotment was issued to the Force in the amount of \$296,804,800 (or 99.7 per cent of the appropriation). Expenditure for the period totalled \$296,804,100 gross (\$291,755,000 net), with a budget implementation rate of 99.7 per cent, which reflects: (a) higher-than-budgeted expenditure under military and police personnel; (b) lower-than-budgeted expenditure under civilian personnel; and (c) lower-than-budgeted expenditure under operational costs.

3. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that redeployments in the amount of \$13,984,400 to group I (military and police personnel) resulted from expenditures in excess due to actual requirements related to a new higher-cost contract for rations and higher actual rates for mission subsistence allowance. The Committee was informed that the positive balances under group II (civilian personnel) and group III (operational costs) were attributable primarily to savings resulting from efforts to prioritize and curtail spending due to ongoing liquidity constraints. Additional savings realized under group III resulted from the cancellation of one fixed-wing aircraft contract and the unavailability of one rotary-wing aircraft due to scheduled maintenance and unforeseen technical issues. **The Advisory Committee trusts that more detailed information on redeployments will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of consideration of the present report, in particular on activities curtailed and other lower-than-budgeted expenditures that allowed for resources to be redeployed and criteria used by missions to reprioritize resources.**

4. The Advisory Committee notes from the supplementary information provided to it that, as at 30 June 2025, unliquidated obligations for 2024/25 amounted to \$32,993,100 (or 11.1 per cent of the appropriation), representing a decrease of \$507,700 compared with the amount of \$33,500,800 as at 30 June 2024 for the 2023/24 period. Upon enquiry, the Committee was informed that, as at 31 January 2026, unliquidated obligations had decreased to \$5,351,000 (or 1.8 per cent of the total appropriation) for the 2024/25 period, comprising military and police personnel (\$240,100), civilian personnel (\$40,200) and operational costs (\$5,070,000).

5. The unencumbered balance, in gross terms, amounts to \$972,100, or 0.3 per cent of the overall level of resources approved for the financial period. A detailed analysis of variances is provided in section III of the report of the Secretary-General. Information provided to the Advisory Committee indicates that other revenue and adjustments for the 2024/25 period amount to \$3,991,200, comprising: (a) investment revenue (\$2,041,700); (b) other/miscellaneous revenue (\$171,600); and (c) the

cancellation of prior-period obligations (\$1,777,900). The Committee notes the proposal in paragraphs 50 and 52 of the report of the Secretary-General that credits arising from the above-mentioned revenue and adjustments be placed in a reserve that would be used in the event that collections are insufficient to enable the full, efficient and effective implementation of mandates (see para. 58 below).

Matters pertaining to the report of the Board of Auditors

6. In considering the report of the Secretary-General, the Advisory Committee also had before it the report of the Board of Auditors on the accounts of the United Nations peacekeeping operations for the financial period ended 30 June 2025 ([A/80/5 \(Vol. II\)](#)). Regarding UNISFA, the Board noted issues in terms of idle assets transferred from the United Nations Multidimensional Integrated Stabilization Mission in Mali (MINUSMA) to UNISFA, assets transferred from MINUSMA to UNISFA approved for write-off as “lost in transit” but without corresponding insurance claims; contract deficiencies; excessive holdings of dead stock; and significant liquidity-related impacts on mandate delivery, particularly on air operations (*ibid.*, chap. II, paras. 114, 117, 126, 127, 267 and 272). **The Advisory Committee trusts that the mission will file the necessary insurance claims and provide an update on the current status of assets transferred from MINUSMA to UNISFA, as well as further clarification on the challenges in allocation processes that led to some being idle for over one year, to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report. The Committee further trusts that the recommendations of the Board of Auditors will be implemented in a timely manner.**

III. Information on performance for the current period

7. Regarding current and projected expenditure for the period from 1 July 2025 to 30 June 2026, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 28 February 2026, expenditure amounted to \$160,745,800, or 52.0 per cent of the appropriation of \$309,120,900. At the end of the current period, the estimated total expenditure would amount to \$266,789,700,¹ representing an implementation rate of 86.3 per cent of the appropriation. **The Advisory Committee notes that all missions have been requested to implement 15 per cent savings for the 2025/26 period, as part of the contingency plan (25 per cent for the United Nations Support Office in Somalia). The Committee also notes that UNISFA projects an expenditure level of 86.3 per cent of the appropriation. The Committee trusts that updated expenditure projections and further clarification thereon will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and in the performance report for the 2025/26 period.**

8. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that UNISFA implemented a 15 per cent reduction in expenditure for the 2025/26 period, in accordance with the contingency plan. The mission applied a structured, risk-informed prioritization process that first safeguarded non-discretionary minimum operating requirements and essential contractual obligations before allocating remaining resources to discretionary but mandate-critical activities. Under group I, 458 uniformed personnel were repatriated; the mission continued to operate five rations delivery points following the closure of one; one team site was closed and another was expected to close shortly, with all troops from both locations relocated to Abyei. Under group II, measures included a full recruitment freeze on vacant posts and positions, non-extension of selected temporary appointments, and discontinuation

¹ Excludes one-time requirements for termination entitlements payable to staff members.

of contracts associated with locations designated for closure or reconfiguration. Under group III, measures included a reduction in programmatic activities, suspension of quick-impact projects, delays to camp reconstruction projects, reductions in aviation assets, and suspension of all non-essential travel, training, and related activities. UNISFA considers that some measures may reduce flexibility in addressing peak or unforeseen demands, and some may carry secondary impacts. The Committee was also informed that operational constraints along the northern main supply route resulted in higher contract and supply chain costs and that the drone strike at Kadugli resulted in unplanned expenditures estimated at \$11.2 million (see also paras. 13, 42 and 50 below).

9. **The Advisory Committee notes that UNISFA applied a structured, risk-informed prioritization process that first protected the minimum operating requirements deemed non-discretionary. The Committee trusts that an update and more detailed assessment of the impact of the implementation of the contingency plan on the mission mandate will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the report and in the next performance report. The Committee also trusts that all efforts will be undertaken to ensure the security and safety of personnel.**

10. The Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 2 February 2026, a total of \$4,378,493,000 had been assessed on Member States in respect of UNISFA since its inception. Payments received as at the same date amounted to \$4,197,809,000, leaving an outstanding balance of \$180,684,000. As at 2 February 2026, the cash available amounted to \$75,392,000, which was sufficient to cover the three-month operating reserve of \$54,752,000 (excluding reimbursements to troop- and police-contributing countries).

11. The Advisory Committee notes from the supplementary information provided to it that, as at 31 December 2025, the outstanding balance for troop costs and contingent-owned equipment amounted to \$12,988,600 and \$37,264,900, respectively. As at 2 February 2026, \$2,649,000 had been paid to settle 101 death and disability claims since the inception of the Force, and 4 claims were pending. **The Advisory Committee trusts that all outstanding liabilities and claims will be settled in a timely manner.**

IV. Proposed budget for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027

A. Mandate and planning assumptions

12. The mandate of UNISFA was established by the Security Council in its resolution [1990 \(2011\)](#) and most recently extended by the Council in its resolution [2802 \(2025\)](#), until 15 November 2026. The planning assumptions and mission support initiatives of UNISFA for 2026/27 are summarized in section I.C of the report of the Secretary-General.

Operational constraints

13. According to information provided to the Advisory Committee, the security environment in the UNISFA area of operations continued to present a complex and evolving risk landscape, with emerging aerial threat vectors, particularly the use of unmanned aerial systems, which significantly increased the threat profile against UNISFA personnel, assets, and programme delivery. The Committee was informed that the drone attack in Kadugli, combined with wider regional dynamics, had direct

implications on force protection, freedom of movement, infrastructure resilience, and the continuity of mandate implementation in UNISFA. For instance, following the attack, and given the unforeseeable nature of the drone threat, the Joint Border Verification and Monitoring Mechanism withdrew from one team site and is planning the withdrawal from the remaining team site. Furthermore, in light of the constrained operating environment, including the drone strike and closure of Kadugli base, and the high contract and supply chain costs resulting from restrictions along the northern main supply route, the Force's operational approach was adjusted as reflected in the 2025/26 spending patterns and in the proposed 2026/27 budget.

14. The Advisory Committee trusts that updated information on the operational environment of the Force, and its implication on budgetary requirements, will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and in future budget reports. The Committee further trusts that more detailed information on risk mitigation measures planned and adopted by the mission will be provided in future reports (see also paras. 49–52 below).

15. Upon enquiry on the use of technology and the implementation of the mandate related to the work of the Joint Border Verification and Monitoring Mechanism, the Advisory Committee was informed that, to enhance situational awareness in areas with limited air and ground access, UNISFA was exploring technological monitoring tools such as unmanned aerial systems, satellite imagery supported by artificial intelligence, and real-time geospatial platforms. However, the use of these technologies would be aimed at enhancing efficiency and strengthening monitoring under current access constraints, not at reducing existing troop requirements, as the Quick Reaction Force and national monitors would continue to be required for physical verification.

Impact of the UN80 Initiative and culture of efficiency

16. Information on efficiency gains is provided in section II.C of the report of the Secretary-General. The cost estimates for 2026/27 take into account efficiency initiatives derived from targeted structural adjustments, operational streamlining, and optimized resource utilization under military observers and contingents, civilian personnel, facilities and infrastructure, ground transportation, communications and information technology, air operations, medical and mine action, in the amount of \$35,590,600. This represents an 11.5 per cent reduction compared with the approved budget for 2025/26, in the context of an overall 10.3 per cent proposed reduction (see para. 19 below) (A/80/614, para. 49). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, to ensure that efficiencies are sustainable, align with UN80 Initiative principles and do not compromise the ability to implement the mandate or sustain essential operational capabilities within its self-sustained operating environment, the UNISFA approach focused on targeted, evidence-based efficiencies rather than across-the-board reductions.

17. As regards the reversibility of the contingency plan, the Advisory Committee was informed that, for the 2026/27 period, UNISFA anticipates restoring priority programmatic activities and quick-impact projects, optimizing existing air operations capacity, and proceeding with deferred infrastructure and camp reconstruction projects essential to mandate implementation. Overall, the reversibility component is intended to ensure that none of the contingency measures implemented in 2025/26 become permanent reductions unless required, thereby maintaining the mission's ability to deliver on its mandate effectively once the liquidity situation stabilizes.

18. The Advisory Committee notes that, while part of proposed reductions reflect structural efficiency gains resulting from process improvements, some

result from constraints in the area of operations and others are driven by liquidity constraints and temporary expenditure compression. The Committee trusts that further information on the connection between the proposed reductions and changes in the expected accomplishments and outputs proposed for UNISFA for 2026/27 will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report, to allow for a better assessment of the sustainability and long-term implications of such measures on the implementation of the mandate of the mission. The Advisory Committee further discusses efficiency measures in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations (A/80/604).

B. Resource requirements

19. The total resource requirements in the amount of \$277,238,100 for the period 2026/27 represent a decrease of \$31,882,800, or 10.3 per cent, compared with the apportionment of \$309,120,900 for 2025/26. Information on variances between the apportionment for 2025/26 and the proposed resources for 2026/27 is contained in section III of the proposed budget.

Financial resources

(Thousands of United States dollars)

Category	Approved (2024/25)	Expenditure (2024/25)	Apportionment (2025/26)	Expenditure as at 28 February 2026	Cost estimates (2026/27)	Variance	
						Amount	Percentage
Military and police personnel	121 382.1	135 366.5	133 793.0	74 257.3	117 294.6	(16 498.4)	(12.3)
Civilian personnel	56 690.9	55 559.3	58 308.9	35 249.6	51 077.4	(7 231.5)	(12.4)
Operational costs	119 703.2	105 878.3	117 019.0	51 238.9	108 866.1	(8 152.9)	(7.0)
Gross requirements	297 776.2	296 804.1	309 120.9	160 745.8	277 238.1	(31 882.8)	(10.3)

1. Military and police personnel

Category	Authorized 2024/25	Actual as at 30 June 2025	Authorized 2025/26 ^a	Actual as at 28 February 2026	Authorized and proposed for 2026/27	Variance
Military and police personnel						
Military observers	135	126	135	68	135	—
Military contingents	3 115	3 112	3 115	2 731	3 115	—
United Nations police	148	56	148	60	148	—
Formed police units	492	—	492	—	492	—

^a Represents the highest level of authorized strength.

Delayed deployment factors

(Percentage of approved strength)

<i>Category</i>	<i>Budgeted 2024/25</i>	<i>Actual 2024/25</i>	<i>Budgeted 2025/26</i>	<i>Actual as at 28 February 2026</i>	<i>Actual average as at 28 February 2026</i>	<i>Projected 2026/27</i>
Military and police personnel						
Military observers	10.4	6.7	7.4	49.6	28.9	44.4
Military contingents	2.9	0.1	0.2	12.3	4.5	12.6
United Nations police	70.3	62.2	64.9	59.5	62.2	61.5
Formed police units	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0

20. The proposed resources for military and police personnel for 2026/27 amount to \$117,294,600, reflecting a decrease of \$16,498,400, or 12.3 per cent, compared with the apportionment of \$133,793,000 for 2025/26. The decrease is attributable primarily to the application of higher vacancy rates for military observers and military contingents, offset in part by the application of a lower vacancy rate for United Nations police (A/80/614, paras. 62–67).

21. The Advisory Committee notes that the 458 uniformed personnel repatriated as part of the contingency plan in 2025/26 comprised 57 military observers and 401 military contingents. The proposed return of military and police personnel repatriated following the implementation of the contingency plan, and taking into consideration a delayed deployment factor, will result in an average deployment of 7 military observers and 16 military contingents above the post-contingency plan deployment levels, as well as an additional 5 United Nations police, for the 2026/27 period.

22. **The Advisory Committee recommends the approval of the proposals of the Secretary-General for military and police personnel.**

2. Civilian personnel

<i>Category</i>	<i>Approved 2024/25</i>	<i>Encumbered as at 30 June 2025</i>	<i>Approved 2025/26</i>	<i>Encumbered as at 28 February 2026</i>	<i>Proposed 2026/27</i>	<i>Variance</i>
	<i>(1)</i>	<i>(2)</i>	<i>(3)</i>	<i>(4)</i>	<i>(5)</i>	<i>(6)=(5)-(3)</i>
Posts						
International staff	190	165	190	150	185	(5)
National staff						
National Professional Officers	10	10	10	6	10	–
National General Service staff	84	76	83	47	100	17
United Nations Volunteers						
International	38	37	38	34	40	2
National	–	–	1	–	3	2
General temporary assistance						
International	11	10	10	8	10	(1)
National	2	2	1	1	–	–
Total	335	300	333	246	348	15

23. The proposed resources for civilian personnel for the 2026/27 period amount to \$51,077,400, reflecting a decrease of \$8,152,900, or 12.4 per cent, compared with the apportionment of \$58,308,900 for 2025/26. The decrease in requirements is primarily

attributable to the net effect of abolishment of 5 posts and a position, application of higher vacancy rates and removal of the provision for 37 general temporary assistance replacement positions, offset in part by the proposed establishment of 17 posts and 4 positions (*ibid.*, paras. 69–79).

Recommendations on posts and positions

24. The Secretary-General proposes a total of 348 civilian staff for 2026/27, comprising 185 international staff, 110 national staff (10 National Professional Officers and 100 national General Service staff), 10 general temporary positions and 43 United Nations Volunteers, reflecting a net increase of 15 posts. These proposals also reflect the results of the civilian staffing review (see para. 31 below).

Establishment

25. The Secretary-General proposes the establishment of 18 posts (1 P-3 and 17 national General Service) and 4 positions (2 international and 2 national United Nations Volunteers). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was provided with the following information:

(a) Legal Officer (P-3): the responsibilities of the post would include preparing legal opinions and advice to UNISFA leadership and for operational activities. Given that many of the substantive and operational legal matters are managed across multiple host Governments within the UNISFA area of operations, it is proposed that the post be recruited internationally to ensure the effective carrying out of its functions;

(b) Field Language Assistant (national General Service): the 15 posts would be responsible for providing language support within the proposed Translation Unit (see para. 33 below), to mandated activities across all UNISFA components. Due to the nature of their functions, it is proposed that the posts be recruited locally to ensure fluency across the entire spectrum of local languages in the Unit;

(c) Fire Safety Assistant (national General Service): the two posts would be responsible for conducting fire risk assessments; providing training for UNISFA personnel and local focal points; inspection of contingent-owned and United Nations-owned equipment; and operation of firefighting equipment. It is proposed that the posts be recruited locally to allow for close coordination and interaction with the local communities;

(d) Gender Affairs Officer (international United Nations Volunteer): the position would be responsible for providing support for the prevention of and response to sexual and gender-based violence; facilitating local support and monitoring; collecting data; and conducting regular community-level consultations. It is proposed that the position be recruited internationally to ensure the incumbent's ability to safely and effectively work directly with the different communities that fall under the UNISFA area of operations;

(e) Transport Officer (international United Nations Volunteer): the position would be responsible for budget planning and oversight, resource management, performance reporting and contract management for the Transport Unit, as well as overseeing road safety activities, including incident investigations and measures to improve safety standards and reduce incidents of destruction of transport equipment. It is proposed that the position be recruited internationally, given the technical requirements and the multinational nature of the UNISFA area of operations. Upon further enquiry, the Committee was informed that functions of the proposed position were currently undertaken by Transport Assistants (Field Service) and the Chief Transport Officer (P-4) within the Unit. The Committee notes that the Unit currently

has 16 staff, comprising 1 P-4, 1 P-3, 4 Field Service, 7 national General Service and 3 international United Nations Volunteer. **The Advisory Committee considers that adequate staffing capacity of international staff exists in the Transport Unit and therefore recommends against the proposed establishment of the Transport Officer position as an international United Nations Volunteer and, instead, recommends its establishment as a national United Nations Volunteer position;**

(f) Public Information Assistant (national United Nations Volunteer): the two positions would be responsible for communications, digital media, and outreach. With the lack of developed local media in the Abyei Administrative Area, the positions will be essential to establishing the on-the-ground presence of the Communications and Public Relations Office; connecting with local communities and interlocutors; developing culturally specific and sensitive communication materials; and improving mandate awareness at the local level. It is proposed that the posts be recruited locally, given the nature of their responsibilities.

Reassignment

26. The Secretary-General proposes the reassignment of 36 posts (1 P-5, 3 P-4, 5 P-3, 1 P-2, 5 Field Service, 1 National Professional Officer and 20 national General Service) and 2 international United Nations Volunteer positions as a result of organizational changes arising from the civilian staffing review (A/80/614, table after para. 44). The Advisory Committee notes the proposed reassignment of one Management and Programme Analyst (P-4) from the Office of the Chief of Mission Support to Liaison Officer (P-4), and of one Administrative Officer (P-3) from the Sector/Regional Offices to Liaison Officer (P-3), in the Community Liaison Office. The Committee notes that the Community Liaison Office is currently staffed with 12 posts, comprising 1 P-5, 3 P-4, 4 P-3, 1 National Professional Officer and 3 national General Service. **In noting the role of the Community Liaison Office with local community engagement, and considering the number of existing international posts in the Office, the Advisory Committee recommends against the proposed reassignment of one Liaison Officer post at the P-4 level and, instead, recommends its reclassification as National Professional Officer.**

Redeployment

27. The Secretary-General proposes the redeployment of 34 posts (1 P-4, 3 P-3, 13 Field Service, 1 National Professional Officer and 16 national General Service) and 5 international United Nations Volunteer positions, as a result of organizational changes arising from the civilian staffing review (ibid., para. 35 and table after para. 44).

Abolishment

28. The Secretary-General proposes the abolishment of six posts (1 D-1, 2 P-5, 1 P-4, 1 P-3, 1 Field Service). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was provided with the following information:

(a) Chief of Service, Rule of Law (D-1): the duties of the post would be absorbed through reallocation and consolidation of responsibilities within existing structures. Core operational, planning and oversight functions would be integrated into existing senior leadership frameworks, while technical and day-to-day tasks would be redistributed to the other senior-level staff and specialized staff officers to ensure continuity of implementation. Coordination and liaison responsibilities would continue to be carried out through established mechanisms;

(b) Administrative Assistant (Field Service): the duties of the post would no longer be required, owing to the proposed abolishment of the Chief of Service, Rule of Law (D-1), post;

(c) Deputy Police Commissioner (P-5): as one of the primary duties of this post is management and oversight of formed police units in UNISFA, the non-deployment of the units over the past three years has limited the utility of this post. During the vacancy of the post, its duties were redistributed within the UNISFA police component and workflows adjusted accordingly. The requirement for the function will be reassessed once the deployment of formed police units is authorized;

(d) Chief, Supply Chain Management (P-5): the abolishment is proposed in line with the proposed merger of the Service Delivery Services and Supply Chain Management pillars (see para. 32 below);

(e) Auditor (P-4): the audit coordination and monitoring responsibilities performed by the post would remain centralized within the Office of the Chief of Mission Support and be reassigned to the Administrative Officer (P-4). The Auditor (P-4) currently serves as the mission's central focal point for audit matters, handling their coordination and quality assurance. Regarding the reassignment of functions to the Administrative Officer (P-4), UNISFA considers that the functional responsibilities of the Auditor (P-4) post, such as coordinating cross-cutting processes, supporting oversight activities and providing substantive advice to senior management, are already substantially aligned with the standard P-4 Administrative Officer profile, and the reassignment is therefore not expected to create a material gap in expertise. **The Advisory Committee underlines the importance for the mission to ensure timely implementation and quality assurance in response to auditors' recommendations, including maintaining adequate technical expertise and rigour in the review of supporting evidence for the closure of audit recommendations under the revised arrangement;**

(f) Protocol Assistant (Field Service): the post was currently located in Entebbe, Uganda, and its primary functions of managing logistics and administrative arrangements related to official visits and meetings could be managed by other existing personnel, with coordination by the UNISFA regional office in Entebbe.

General temporary assistance

29. The Secretary-General proposes the continuation of the following general temporary assistance positions:

(a) Seven positions in the Mine Action Section (1 P-4, 1 P-3, 1 P-2, 3 Field Service and 1 national General Service) in support of the Force's mine action programme objectives;

(b) Two positions, comprising one Logistics Officer (P-3) in the Mission Support Centre and one Transport Officer (P-3) in the Transport Unit, established as from 1 July 2024 as part of the transition of the delivery model for mine action;

(c) One position of Engineer (P-3), established as from 1 July 2013 in the Engineering and Facilities Management Unit, to oversee ongoing Force mobility projects.

30. The Secretary-General indicates that, as part of the civilian staffing review exercise, 37 general temporary assistance replacement positions and their related provisions were removed from the proposed budget for 2026/27. Of the 37 positions, 17 would be replaced with the national General Service posts proposed for establishment (see para. 25 (b) and (c) above). The remaining 20 would be abolished and their functions absorbed through internal redeployment, reprofiling, and process

optimization. This approach is expected to reduce reliance on temporary staffing and improve cost transparency and workforce stability while preserving essential capacity (A/80/614, para. 32). The Advisory Committee notes that there are no proposed resources under general temporary assistance – other personnel in the proposed budget for 2026/27, compared with the provision of \$1,713,000 in 2025/26 and \$1,619,900 in 2024/25. The Committee recalls its view that the civilian staffing review presented an opportunity for the Secretary-General to critically assess the general temporary assistance replacement positions with a view to determining the need for their continuation and the overall optimization of the staffing structures at UNISFA (A/79/724/Add.11, paras. 19 and 20). **The Advisory Committee acknowledges efforts of the mission to review and regularize the requirements under general temporary assistance positions.**

Civilian staffing review and organizational restructuring

31. The Secretary-General indicates that, during the first half of the 2025/26 period, a civilian staffing review was conducted, and in response, UNISFA implemented targeted staffing adjustments and organizational realignments and also reprofiled existing positions to address operational gaps. It is indicated that, overall, the changes can be implemented within existing resources; support progressive nationalization of critical functions; and streamline support structures without affecting mandate delivery or operational effectiveness (A/80/614, paras. 30 and 31). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that the review was fully aligned with the UN80 Initiative, including through maximization of existing resources, identification of efficiencies and improvement of processes.

32. The Secretary-General indicates that the civilian staffing review also recommended organizational changes, including: (a) implementation of a new two-pillar support structure, comprising the Operations and Resource Management Section and the Supply Chain and Service Delivery Services Section; (b) abolishment of the Sector/Regional Offices unit; (c) establishment of a separate Translation Unit under the Office of the Chief of Staff (Civilian); (d) establishment of a Facilities Management Unit under the new Supply Chain and Service Delivery Services Section; (e) move of the Passenger Booking Unit to within the Movement Control and Distribution Unit; and (f) abolishment of the Audit Response Unit, under the Office of the Chief of Mission Support (ibid., paras. 36–41). **The Advisory Committee stresses the importance of preserving the segregation of duties and of adequate risk monitoring to ensure that the streamlined structure does not undermine internal controls and operational capacities. The Committee looks forward to an assessment of the performance of and challenges experienced by the missions with regard to the implementation of their two-pillar support structures in the next report on the overview of peacekeeping operations.**

33. With regard to the proposed establishment of the Translation Unit under the Office of the Chief of Staff (Civilian), the Advisory Committee was informed that, to enhance its language capacity, UNISFA proposes to establish a centralized pool of 18 Field Language Assistants under the supervision of a Field Translator (P-3). Staff in the Unit would be deployed across UNISFA headquarters and field locations in the Abyei Area, as required, to meet the language support needs of military and police personnel and civilian components. This would strengthen both operational and substantive capacity, addressing a long-standing gap while optimizing resource usage. **The Advisory Committee sees merit in the establishment of the new Translation Unit in UNISFA to meet its operational language needs and trusts that lessons learned on the pooling of language capacity will be provided in future reports and shared with other missions, as appropriate.**

Nationalization

34. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that the 2025 civilian staffing review concluded that, due to limitations in the local labour market in Abyei, the scope for additional nationalization within the Abyei duty station itself remains constrained. However, with the expansion of operations in South Sudan and Uganda, where labour markets are more diversified and technically developed, the potential for nationalization in more technical and operational functions could be progressively re-examined once the UNISFA footprint in these locations is strengthened and stabilized. Notwithstanding these limitations, UNISFA continues to pursue targeted nationalization in areas where local capacity is comparatively stronger. **The Advisory Committee recalls paragraph 34 of General Assembly resolution 76/274 (see also A/78/744, para. 37) and reiterates the view that more efforts should be made to nationalize functions commensurate with mission mandates and requirements, wherever appropriate.**

Vacant posts

35. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 28 February 2026, 74 posts and positions (2 D-2, 5 P-5, 4 P-4, 8 P-3, 1 P-2, 2 National Professional Officer, 15 Field Service, 31 national General Service and 6 United Nations Volunteer) were vacant, of which 4 were vacant for over two years and are not proposed for abolishment. Upon enquiry, the Committee was informed that the Deputy Head of Mission (D-2) post, which has remained vacant since 1 July 2020, pending agreement by the Government of the Sudan, would once again be applied a vacancy rate of 100 per cent during the 2026/27 period (see also A/79/724/Add.11, para. 22), while the recruitment of the other three posts (1 P-3 and 2 national General Service) was on hold in line with the contingency plan. **The Advisory Committee trusts that an update on the number of vacant posts and their recruitment status will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and in the next budget submission. The Committee also trusts that remaining long-vacant posts continue to be critically reviewed in the context of the next budget submission.** The Committee discusses vacant and long-vacant posts in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations (A/80/604).

36. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 31 December 2025, two posts (1 P-3 and 1 Field Service) were encumbered by staff with approved requests for the early separation programme. **The Advisory Committee trusts that detailed and updated information on all staff of the mission approved for the early separation programme, as well as on the related costs, will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of consideration of the present report and in the next budget submission.**

Vacancy rates

37. The Secretary-General indicates in his budget report that the vacancy rates for civilian personnel categories with proposed abolishments were calculated using the number of vacant posts and positions as at 31 December 2025, net of those proposed for abolishment. For categories without abolishments, standard policy was applied, while a vacancy rate of 50 per cent has been applied in the calculation of costs for the proposed establishments and reassignments (A/80/614, para. 55).

Vacancy rates

(Percentage)

<i>Category</i>	<i>Budgeted 2024/25</i>	<i>Actual 2024/25</i>	<i>Budgeted 2025/26</i>	<i>Actual as at 31 December 2025</i>	<i>Actual average, January– December 2025</i>	<i>Actual as at 28 February 2026</i>	<i>Actual average July 2025– February 2026</i>	<i>Proposed 2026/27</i>
Civilian personnel								
International staff	9.6	11.6	10.0	19.5	14.2	21.1	16.8	16.8
National staff								
National Professional Officers	20.0	–	–	30.0	–	40.0	10.0	–
National General Service staff	6.0	8.3	6.0	42.2	10.8	43.4	20.5	21.0
United Nations Volunteers								
International	13.2	2.6	2.6	13.2	5.3	13.2	10.5	5.3
National	n/a	n/a	50.0	100.0	–	100.0	100.0	100.0
General temporary assistance								
International	25.0	9.1	–	30.0	10.0	30.0	20.0	16.7
National	50.0	–	25.0	–	–	100.0	–	–
Government-provided personnel	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a

38. The Advisory Committee notes the difference between the actual and proposed vacancy rate for international staff, national General Service staff and international United Nations Volunteers. The Committee trusts that the Secretary-General will provide updated information on the latest actual and actual average vacancy rates to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report, along with clear justification where the proposed rates differ from the actual rates, including as it relates to the impact of proposed abolishments, realistic projected recruitment and potential upcoming vacancies, to the extent possible.

39. With respect to the high vacancy rate for national General Service staff, the Advisory Committee was informed, upon enquiry, that implementation of the contingency plan, together with the Force's reduced presence in Port Sudan and Kadugli following the independent strategic review in 2025, resulted in the separation of 23 national staff in Port Sudan and Kadugli (27.7 per cent of 83 approved for the 2025/26 period). In addition, nine national staff (a further 10.8 per cent) voluntarily separated under the early separation programme. These separations resulted in a higher-than-budgeted vacancy rate of 43.4 per cent, as at 28 February 2026, compared with the approved rate of 6.0 per cent for the 2025/26 period. The Advisory Committee notes with concern that the vacancy rate of national General Service staff has grown from an actual 8.3 per cent in 2024/25 period to 43.4 per cent as at 28 February 2026. The Committee trusts that efforts will be undertaken by the mission to ensure that national posts are filled as expeditiously as possible.

40. Subject to its recommendations contained in paragraphs 25 (e) and 26 above, the Advisory Committee recommends the approval of the proposals of the Secretary-General for civilian personnel.

3. Operational costs

(Thousands of United States dollars)

Category	Apportionment (2024/25)	Expenditure (2024/25)	Apportionment (2025/26)	Expenditure as at 28 February 2026	Cost estimates (2026/27)	Variance	
						Amount	Percentage
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)=(5)-(3)	(7)=(6)÷(3)
Operational costs							
Civilian electoral observers	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Consultants and consulting services	727.7	712.0	683.0	281.5	683.0	—	—
Official travel	726.5	386.0	693.0	261.9	693.0	—	—
Facilities and infrastructure	44 109.8	41 146.4	46 528.8	15 136.7	47 041.9	513.1	1.1
Ground transportation	4 062.4	2 574.7	5 456.0	919.0	6 755.4	1 299.4	23.8
Air operations	36 332.2	33 148.0	33 950.5	22 007.6	27 403.0	(6 547.5)	(19.3)
Marine operations	472.7	500.3	—	129.3	246.8	246.8	—
Communications and information technology	9 668.8	9 202.6	9 056.0	3 845.2	7 402.0	(1 654.0)	(18.3)
Medical	685.4	433.4	685.2	144.1	602.5	(82.7)	(12.1)
Special equipment	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Other supplies, services and equipment	22 167.7	17 025.5	19 216.5	8 513.6	17 288.5	(1 928.0)	(10.0)
Quick-impact projects	750.0	749.4	750.0	—	750.0	—	—
Total	119 703.2	105 878.3	117 019.0	51 238.9	108 866.1	(8 152.9)	(7.0)

41. The proposed requirements of \$108,866,100 reflect a decrease of \$8,152,900, or 7.0 per cent, compared with the resources approved for 2025/26. The proposed decrease mainly reflects reduced requirements under air operations, communications and information technology, medical, and other supplies, services and equipment, offset in part by increased requirements under ground transportation and facilities and infrastructure (ibid., sects. II and III).

Impact of the main supply route change

42. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that fuel and logistics costs remain major cost drivers for UNISFA due to its reliance on the southern supply route, which is expected to continue given ongoing insecurity along the northern route. The southern route, which is approximately 500 km longer than the northern route and traverses multiple national jurisdictions, has increased the Force's lead times and customs clearance complexity. As a result, the unit cost of transportation has risen two- or threefold. Under existing contracts, the delivery cost per 20-ft equivalent unit is \$3,437.50 via the northern route, compared with \$11,500 via the southern route. **The Advisory Committee trusts that updated information on the financial impact of the supply route change will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and in the next budget submission.**

Facilities and infrastructure

43. The proposed resources amount to \$47,041,900, reflecting an increase of \$513,000 (or 1.1 per cent) compared with the apportionment of \$46,528,800 for 2025/26. For 2024/25 expenditure amounted to \$41,146,400 against the appropriation

of \$44,109,800, and in 2023/24 expenditure amounted to \$34,235,300 against \$37,562,300. The increased requirements are attributable primarily to the camp construction projects at four team sites and camp maintenance services, and the construction of the Wau logistics base (ibid., paras. 83 and 84). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that the first phase of the four-camp construction and the Wau logistics base projects was expected to take place from October 2026 to January 2027, and the second phase from February to May 2027. However, procurement processes have not yet been initiated for the projects. The cost estimates are based on material and service prices from recently completed projects. The Committee was also informed that, to prevent delays as experienced in previous projects, UNISFA carefully sequenced the projects, reflecting realistic implementation capacity, ensuring that the proposed resources are practical, prioritized and deliverable within the 2026/27 period. **The Advisory Committee is of the view that operational restrictions experienced by the mission and the preliminary stage of development may impact the full implementation of the construction projects, and also taking into consideration the pattern of underexpenditure in previous years, the Committee recommends a reduction of 3 per cent (\$944,500) to the proposed resources under facilities and infrastructure, excluding petrol oil and lubricants.**

44. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that a significant portion of the planned construction activities relied on procurement of locally sourced materials, such as murram, which do not incur international freight charges. **The Advisory Committee emphasizes the importance of ensuring the procurement of locally sourced and manufactured materials, as well as utilization of local labour and expertise, when possible, and trusts that updates thereon will be provided in future budget proposals.**

Ground transportation

45. The proposed resources amount to \$6,755,400, reflecting an increase of \$1,299,400 (or 23.8 per cent) compared with the apportionment of \$5,456,000 for 2025/26. Expenditure in 2024/25 amounted to \$2,574,700 against the appropriation of \$4,062,400 and in 2023/24 amounted to \$2,311,600 against the appropriation of \$4,138,400. The increased requirements are attributable primarily to a new solicitation for transport services to replace and consolidate all current workshop and driver operator contracts, along with the planned replacement of 25 light passenger vehicles under the mission's five-year asset replacement plan (ibid., para. 87). The Advisory Committee notes that the repairs and maintenance subclass proposes an amount of \$1,636,400, which represents an increase of \$1,220,400 (or 293.4 per cent) compared with the 2025/26 period. **The Advisory Committee trusts that further information on the new solicitation for transport services, status of procurement, operational benefits and efficiencies to be achieved with the new contract will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of consideration of the present report and in the next report.** Information provided to the Committee shows that UNISFA proposes to replace 25 vehicles in 2026/27 at a cost of \$1,000,000, 59 vehicles in 2027/28 at \$2,360,000, 44 vehicles in 2028/29 at \$1,760,000 and 27 vehicles in 2029/30 at \$1,080,000, for a total of 155 vehicles in 2026/27–2030/31 and a total amount of \$6,200,000, in line with the mission's five-year asset replacement plan. **The Advisory Committee notes the significant level of underexpenditure under ground transportation in recent years and, therefore, recommends that the proposed resources for ground transportation be reduced by 5 per cent (\$337,800).**

Petrol, oil and lubricants

46. A total provision of \$24,491,745 is proposed for fuel, oil and lubricants for the 2026/27 period, reflecting a decrease of \$3,535,972, or 12.6 per cent, due mainly to changes in fuel costs under facilities and infrastructure and ground transportation, and lower estimated required litres of fuel under facilities and infrastructure and air operations in the budget period. **The Advisory Committee trusts that updated information on fuel costs will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report.** The Committee discusses fuel costs and management in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations (A/80/604).

Quick-impact projects

47. Information on quick-impact projects is provided in paragraphs 60 and 61 of the report of the Secretary-General, with proposed resources of \$750,000, reflecting no change compared with 2025/26, for 25 projects. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, for the 2024/25 period, all 24 projects were successfully completed and benefited approximately 70,000 individuals. However, owing to the implementation of the contingency plan, and the 2025 drone attack at Kadugli, UNISFA redeployed resources for quick-impact projects to provide for increased requirements related to uniformed personnel, as well as for critical services necessary to maintain UNISFA operations. Consequently, such projects are not anticipated to be implemented in 2025/26. For 2026/27, UNISFA proposes to prioritize such projects in the areas of water, education, community development, empowerment of women and youth, livelihoods, peacebuilding, the rule of law, traditional justice, and provision of non-food items for internally displaced persons. **While cognizant of the challenges imposed by liquidity constraints, the Advisory Committee trusts that efforts will be undertaken to ensure continuation of quick-impact projects, to the extent possible, so that projects benefit the local population, as intended.**

48. **Subject to the recommendations contained in paragraphs 43 and 45 above, the Advisory Committee recommends the approval of the proposals of the Secretary-General for operational costs.**

V. Other matters

Safety and security of United Nations personnel

49. With respect to the drone attack at the UNISFA Kadugli base in December 2025, which resulted in the death of six peacekeepers and injuries to nine others, the Advisory Committee was informed that, in view of the immediate and grave risks to personnel, UNISFA withdrew from the base under exceptionally challenging circumstances. The Committee was also informed that the drone attack underscored the intent and capability of hostile actors to employ military-grade unmanned aerial systems against the Organization. UNISFA continues to review the attack, and a determination on whether the Force was deliberately targeted is outstanding and the attribution of the attack remains unresolved. As the attack had direct implications for UNISFA operations, in response, UNISFA initiated an ad hoc sustainable readiness model, focused on threats from unmanned aerial systems. Risk mitigation measures will be identified and implemented. UNISFA expects that implementing these measures will have operational and resource implications. In the interim, UNISFA has reinforced its defensive measures and updated preparedness drills and is assessing options for counter-unmanned aerial systems detection and mitigation.

50. The Advisory Committee was informed that the drone strike resulted in unplanned expenditures estimated at \$11.2 million, owing to: (a) abandonment of contingent-owned equipment (\$8,143,000); (b) destruction of United Nations-owned equipment and assets (\$2,164,000); (c) claims for death and disability (8 casualties) (\$616,000); (d) medical invoices from third party service providers (to date; partial) (\$150,000); (e) increased fuel costs (\$77,600); (f) evacuation of national civilian staff from Kadugli (to date; partial) (\$18,750); (g) repatriation of human remains (\$24,000); and (h) travel of escorts and others (to date; partial) (\$20,000). These unforeseen costs placed additional strain on the Force's already limited resources.

51. The Advisory Committee expresses its concern regarding the threat to life and to the safety and security of UNISFA personnel. The Committee pays tribute to all UNISFA personnel who have lost their lives or been injured in the service of peace. The Committee also expresses concern regarding the destruction of contingent-owned and United Nations-owned installations and assets.

52. The Advisory Committee trusts that further information on measures undertaken by the mission to mitigate risks from unmanned aerial systems will be provided in future reports. The Committee further discusses unmanned aerial systems in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations (ibid.).

Environmental initiatives

53. The Secretary-General indicates that, during the 2026/27 period, UNISFA will advance its environmental initiatives through the construction of waste management yards at four team sites; and the construction of lift station pumps at three team sites and installation of water pumps and appurtenances at two team sites (A/80/614, paras. 25 and 49). Supplementary information provided to the Advisory Committee indicates that the use of renewable energy will increase from 2 per cent to 18 per cent from 2026/27 to 2027/28, owing to the installation of ten 1,000 kW per hour solar photovoltaic farms in 10 UNISFA camps as part of the camp reconstruction projects. Regarding efficiency gains, an investment of \$7,683,500 and cumulated efficiency gains of \$779,000 are recorded since inception, with \$2,526,700 estimated for the 2026/27 period. **The Advisory Committee notes the continuing efforts of the Force to improve its environmental footprint and that efficiency gains have not yet offset investments. The Committee trusts that further efficiency gains will be generated from energy and environmental initiatives and will be reflected in future reports.** The Committee further discusses environmental activities and energy efficiency in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations (A/80/604).

Management of sea containers

54. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that UNISFA currently holds 2,944 containers, used as follows: (a) 2,065 for storage of materials and equipment pending the construction of centralized warehouse facilities; (b) 483 to support transportation and temporary storage across the UNISFA area of operations; (c) 110 for perimeter wall projects; (d) 44 as protective bunkers; (e) 38 for the level II hospital security fence; and (f) 200 for the Amiet market project. The Committee was also informed that, in December 2024, UNISFA initiated a rationalization exercise to optimize container holdings, with surplus units being written off or repurposed for use in security infrastructure, and obsolete ones disposed of in accordance with established guidelines. The Committee further discusses the management of containers in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations (ibid.).

Equitable geographical representation and gender parity

55. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 31 December 2025, UNISFA comprised 245 staff at all levels. Of the 160 international staff, 62 nationalities were represented. Of the total of 245 staff, 183 were men and 62 were women.²

56. As at 31 December 2025, international staff were from the following regional groups: African States (85); Asia-Pacific States (38); Eastern European States (15); Latin American and Caribbean States (5); Western European and other States (10), as well as the United States of America (5); and other (2).

57. **The Advisory Committee trusts that UNISFA will further increase its efforts to promote equitable geographical representation and gender parity within the mission.** The Advisory Committee discusses equitable geographical representation and gender parity in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations (ibid.).

VI. Conclusion

58. The actions to be taken by the General Assembly with regard to the financing of UNISFA for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025 are indicated in section IV of the report of the Secretary-General (A/80/614). **The Advisory Committee notes the unencumbered balance of \$972,100 for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025, as well as other revenue amounting to \$3,991,200 from investment revenue (\$2,041,700), other/miscellaneous revenue (\$171,600) and the cancellation of prior-period obligations (\$1,777,900) for the period ended 30 June 2025. The Committee also notes the proposal of the Secretary-General to place the credits arising from the above-mentioned revenue and adjustments in a reserve that would be used in the event that collections are insufficient to enable the full, efficient and effective implementation of mandates. The Committee considers that this is a policy matter to be decided by the General Assembly.** The Advisory Committee makes further comments in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations (A/80/604).

59. The actions to be taken by the General Assembly with regard to the financing of UNISFA for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 are indicated in section IV of the report of the Secretary-General (A/80/614). **Taking into account its observations and recommendations above, the Advisory Committee recommends that the proposed resources be reduced by \$1,398,800, from \$277,238,100 to \$275,839,300. Accordingly, the Committee recommends that the General Assembly appropriate the amount of \$275,839,300 for the maintenance of the Force for the 12-month period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027.** A summary of the budgetary impact and the financial implications resulting from the recommendations of the Advisory Committee with regard to the financing of UNISFA for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 is presented in the table below.

² Detailed and updated information on nationalities represented at UNISFA is available on the United Nations Secretariat Workforce Portal.

Budgetary impact and financial implications resulting from the recommendations of the Advisory Committee for the United Nations Interim Security Force for Abyei for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027

<i>Category</i>	<i>Paragraph number (present report)</i>	<i>Recommendation of the Advisory Committee</i>	<i>Financial implication (United States dollars)</i>
Posts/staffing changes			
International staff	26	Reclassification of the P-4 post proposed for reassignment as a National Professional Officer post	(161 700)
National staff	26	Reclassification of the P-4 post proposed for reassignment as a National Professional Officer post	60 200
United Nations Volunteers	25 (e)	Establishment of the United Nations Volunteer position as national, not international	(15 000)
Subtotal, posts/staffing changes			(116 500)
Operational costs			
Facilities and infrastructure	43	A reduction of 3 per cent to the proposed resources under facilities and infrastructure, excluding petrol, oil and lubricants	(944 500)
Ground transportation	45	A reduction of 5 per cent to the proposed resources for ground transportation	(337 800)
Subtotal, operational costs			(1 282 300)
Total			(1 398 800)